

Board 1

East Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 8 7 6
♥ 5
♦ A J 10 4
♣ J 8 5 3

♠ K 3 2

♥ A 9 4 2

♦ 9 6 5

♣ K Q 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A J 10 4

♥ J

♦ K Q 7 3

♣ A 7 4 2

♠ 9 5

♥ K Q 10 8 7 6 3

♦ 8 2

♣ 10 9

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

3♠

3♥

Dbl

All Pass

3♠ by North

You dealt this hand.

You make a simple 3♥ opening bid and then the fireworks start. South doubles, your partner passes and North bids 3♠.

Do not preempt the same hand twice. The idea of a preemptive bid is that you bid it's maximum at your first turn. If there is to any further competing on this hand partner will have to do it.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 8 6 3 2
 ♥ K 8
 ♦ A 9 6 4
 ♣ A 7 3

♠ 10 7
 ♥ A J 10 7 4
 ♦ -
 ♣ K Q 10 9 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 4
 ♥ 6 5 2
 ♦ K Q J 10 8 7 3
 ♣ 8 5

♠ A K Q J 9 5
 ♥ Q 9 3
 ♦ 5 2
 ♣ J 6

West

North

East

South

4♦

All Pass

4♦ by East

3♦

3♠

The bidding has been as shown.

You do not have the 4 fast winners you need to raise partner to the 4-level. But you do have 4 of his trumps and 2 and a half winners. And your side doesn't have much defense against a 3♠ contract. You should raise partner to 4♦ because you think they can make 3♠. With these hands it appears they might have gone to 4♠ in which case you would have had to decide whether to continue to 5♦. More judgement would be called for, based on Vulnerability, whether you think they can make the game, etc. The Law of Total Tricks can be a help in these competitive situations; it would lead you to 5♦.

Board 3

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 5

♥ 6

♦ A Q 10 8 7 6 3

♣ 10 9 5

♠ J 7 6 2

♥ A Q 9 3 2

♦ K 5

♣ A 8



♠ A 8

♥ 8 7 4

♦ J 9 4 2

♣ K 6 3 2

♠ K Q 10 4 3

♥ K J 10 5

♦ -

♣ Q J 7 4

West

3 ♦

North

Dbl

East

4 ♦

South

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by South

You dealt this hand.

You open 3 ♦. North doubles, partner raises to 4 ♦, and South bids 4 ♥.

You just pass. Partner's raise was probably just advancing your preempt and they got to 4 ♥ anyway. Sometimes preempts don't do the full job.

It is partner's decision, not yours, whether to continue to 5 ♦ as a sacrifice.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 8 5 3

♥ A Q J 9 8 4 3

♦ 10 7 6

♣ -

♠ J 10 2

♥ K 10 6

♦ A K

♣ 10 9 5 4 2



♠ 9 6 4

♥ -

♦ 8 5 4 2

♣ A K Q J 8 3

♠ A K Q 7

♥ 7 5 2

♦ Q J 9 3

♣ 7 6

The bidding has been as shown.

The guidelines in the summary would have you bid 4♥. After all you very clearly have four quick winners.

But you also have seven quick losers in the other suits, and a trump void to boot.

Somewhere in some of these lessons there should be a guideline that says:

West

North

East

South

3♥

All Pass

3♥ by West

Board 5

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J
 ♥ K Q 10 5 4
 ♦ K J 10 2
 ♣ J 7 6

♠ A K 10 8 7 6 3

♥ 6

♦ 8 4

♣ 10 9 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 4 2

♥ 9 7 2

♦ A 9 3

♣ A 8 4 3

♠ Q 5

♥ A J 8 3

♦ Q 7 6 5

♣ K Q 2

West

1 ♥

North

3 ♠

East

South

All Pass

3 ♠ by North

The bidding has been as shown.

The fact that West opened doesn't change your hand at all. You had planned on **Opening 3 ♠**, now you make a **Weak Jump Overcall** of 3 ♠. If partner has some "stuff" you might get to a makeable contract, and if he doesn't you may keep the opponents out of a ♥ game.

This time everybody passes.

Board 6

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A K 7 2

♥ Q 7

♦ A 5 4 2

♣ A 9 5

♠ J 10 8 6

♥ A 5

♦ J

♣ K Q J 10 8 2



♠ Q

♥ K J 10 9 6 4 2

♦ 10 8

♣ 7 6 4

♠ 9 5 4 3

♥ 8 3

♦ K Q 9 7 6 3

♣ 3

The bidding has been as shown.

You have four quick winners. If partner had opened 3♥ you would have bid 4♥ in the blink of an eye. His Weak Jump Overcall describes the exact same hand. So blink and bid 4♥.

*West**North**East**South*

1♣

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by East